Legend (or) key

A legend or key of a map explains the symbols that are used on it to represent various physical and cultural features. The common signs and symbols which are internationally accepted and used in maps are called conventional signs and symbols. Every map has a legend or a key which explains the different colours and symbols used in it. On a map it is difficult to show the real shape such as settlements, bridges, post offices, railway lines and forests They are depicted by using certain colours, symbols or letters.



India Physical Features

Colours	Features
White	Snow
Yellow	Agriculture
Green	Forest
Blue	Water bodies (oceans, seas and rivers)
Brown	Mountain, Hill and Contour
Red	Settlements, Road
Black	Railway line

Conventional signs and symbols

A sign is a widely used symbol or a line pattern or a colour on a map. It represents a feature on the ground. The Survey of India (SOI) have standardized a set of convectional signs and symbols. Several colours are commonly used in the map.

- Major Road
- Minor Road
- Bridge
- RS — Railway Station
- Railway Broad Gauge
- Railway Metre Gauge
- River
- Canal
- Dam
- Lake
- Wetland
- Mountain
- Volcano
- Grass & Shrub
- Forest
- Country Capital
- Internal Administrative Capital
- Temple
- PO — Post Office
- TO — Telegraph Office
- PS — Police Station
- Fort

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